



PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

OUTSMARTING DIGITAL DECEPTIONS

THE RISING TIDE

PHISHING ATTACK STATISTICS

1M+

Phishing Attacks Daily

90%

Of Breaches Start Here

\$4.4M

Average Breach Cost

Phishing remains the #1 attack vector. Every organization is a target. The question isn't **if** you'll be attacked—it's **when**.



ANATOMY OF A PHISHING EMAIL

SPOT THE RED FLAGS

✗ FROM: support@paypa1.com

✗ SUBJECT: URGENT: Verify Your Account Immediately

Dear Valued Customer,

Your account has been compromised. Click here to verify your identity NOW or lose access.

✗ LINK: <http://paypa1-verify.tk/login>

🚩 RED FLAGS:

- Sender mismatch (paypa1 ≠ paypal)
- Artificial urgency
- Suspicious domain

✓ SAFE PRACTICES:

- Verify sender email
- Never click links
- Go directly to website

SPOTTING FAKE WEBSITES

THE HTTPS PADLOCK MYTH

✗ MYTH: HTTPS = Safe

A padlock icon only means data is encrypted in transit. Scammers can get SSL certificates too. A fake site can be 100% encrypted.

FAKE URL:

`https://paypal.com/login`

Typosquatting: "1" looks like "l"

REAL URL:

`https://paypal.com/login`

Verify domain before entering credentials

Always check the domain. Hover over links. Never trust the padlock alone.



THE ART OF SOCIAL ENGINEERING

EXPLOITING HUMAN PSYCHOLOGY

AUTHORITY

Impersonating executives, IT support, or government agencies to demand compliance.

URGENCY

Creating time pressure: "Act now or lose access," "Verify immediately," "Limited time."

FEAR/GREED

Exploiting emotions: account compromise, prize winnings, financial threats.

DEFENSE:

Pause. Breathe. Verify independently. Legitimate requests don't require panic.



BEYOND EMAIL: MULTI-CHANNEL ATTACKS

SMISHING, VISHING, QUISHING

SMISHING

SMS-based phishing

"Click here to confirm your bank details"
via text message.

VISHING

Voice-based phishing

Phone calls impersonating your bank
asking for account info.

QUISHING

QR code phishing

Malicious QR codes redirecting to fake
login pages.

✓ STAY SAFE:

Never share credentials via phone, text, or QR codes. Verify through official channels.



THE AI EVOLUTION OF PHISHING

DEEPAKES & HYPER-PERSONALIZATION

THE NEW THREAT LANDSCAPE



Deepfake Videos:

CEOs requesting wire transfers via convincing video calls



AI-Generated Content:

Perfectly written emails with zero grammar errors



Hyper-Personalization:

Attackers use LinkedIn, social media to craft targeted lures



Real-Time Adaptation:

AI learns from your responses and adjusts tactics

 CRITICAL:

Traditional defenses are insufficient. Human vigilance + technology = survival.



REAL-WORLD IMPACT: CASE STUDIES

LESSONS FROM MAJOR BREACHES

Google & Facebook (\$100M+ Loss)

Attackers impersonated vendors via email, requesting wire transfers. Employees processed payments without verification.

Sony Pictures (2014)

Spear phishing emails led to credential theft, resulting in massive data breach and operational shutdown.

Twitter (2020)

Employees fell for phishing emails, leading to account takeovers of high-profile users and reputational damage.

KEY TAKEAWAY:

No organization is too big to be vulnerable. Everyone is a target.



YOUR DEFENSE SHIELD

BEST PRACTICES & DO'S AND DON'TS

✓ DO'S

- Verify sender email address
- Hover over links before clicking
- Use Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- Report suspicious emails
- Keep software updated
- Use password managers

✗ DON'TS

- Don't click unsolicited links
- Don't share credentials via email
- Don't ignore security warnings
- Don't reuse passwords
- Don't trust the padlock alone
- Don't open attachments from strangers

MFA is Non-Negotiable:

Even if your password is compromised, MFA prevents unauthorized access.



INTERACTIVE SCENARIO: THE CEO'S REQUEST

QUIZ 01 - CAN YOU SPOT THE PHISHING?

Scenario: You receive an email from your CEO requesting urgent purchase of \$50,000 in gift cards for a client meeting. The email says "Process this immediately and keep it confidential."

What do you do?

- A) Process the request immediately
- B) Call the CEO directly to verify (don't use email)
- C) Ask the CEO to send the request from their personal phone

✓ CORRECT ANSWER: B - Always verify requests through independent channels. This is a classic CEO fraud scam.



INTERACTIVE SCENARIO: THE FAKE SECURITY ALERT

QUIZ 02 - FAKE PASSWORD RESET

Scenario: You receive an email from "IT Security" with subject "URGENT: Reset Your Password Now" and a link to reset your password. The email mentions suspicious login activity.

What's your response?

- A) Click the link and reset your password
- B) Go directly to the company portal (not via email link) and change your password
- C) Ignore it—if it was real, IT would contact you differently

✓ CORRECT ANSWER: B - Never click links in security emails. Always navigate directly to the official site.

YOU ARE THE FIRST LINE OF DEFENSE

Technology can help, but human vigilance is irreplaceable. Every email, every link, every request deserves scrutiny.

 **REPORT SUSPICIOUS ACTIVITY:**
security@company.com

 **SECURITY HOTLINE:**
+1-XXX-SECURITY

STAY ALERT. STAY SAFE. STAY SECURE.